Riverside Riichi 2025 (Riichi, MERS 3)

Observer: Linxuan He

Date: October 25th–26th, 2025

Place: Bristol, United Kingdom

Website or other source(s) of information: All information on the website of Bristol Riichi Mahjong: https://bristol.riichi.page/riverside-riichi-2025/

Participants: 80 players including 2 substitute players.

Represented countries

GBR	ESP	---	ROU	POL	IRL	HKG	BEL
71	2	2	1	1	1	1	1

Playing schedule: 2 days, 5+3 hanchan.

Location: Bristol Bridge Club. 99 Oldfield Rd, Hotwells, Bristol BS8 4QQ

Equipment: We played with mixed sets from UKMA and the Bristol Riichi Mahjong club, overall all in good condition.

Refereeing: Tom Pearson and James Johns were non-player referees, Martin Lester was player referee.

Complaints: Several minor points were raised by a few players:

- Delayed or insufficient response to excessive noise; repeated requests to be quiet were needed.
- Non-uniform equipment (sets and point sticks) between tables.
- Some rounds were started while not all tables had completed wall-building.
- Temperature differences near open doors not communicated in advance.

Information / communication during the tournament:
Players were kept well-informed throughout the event. A large, projected clock was visible to all, and referees provided clear announcements for the start, 10-minute warning, and end of each session. Rankings were updated promptly after each hanchan and were conveniently available on the tournament website.

Sessions: The overall atmosphere during the games was excellent, players were supportive, polite, and engaged, making for enjoyable games.

Catering: Very good. Lunches on site from a catering company and a good selection of snacks, refreshments available throughout.

Prizes: Trophies for individual ranking (1st, 2nd and 3rd), and one more for the best hanchan.

Conclusion: A very successful and well-attended tournament, achieving its full capacity of 80 players. The event was run in an excellent, friendly atmosphere, supported by very good catering and communication, particularly the clear announcements and convenient online ranking system. The minor issues reported, such as noise control, equipment uniformity, and starting procedures, are small operational points that can be easily addressed for future events to further enhance the player experience. Overall, a high-quality and enjoyable tournament.